

Anointing

This document focuses on the practice of **anointing with oil and ointment** in Biblical times. It explores the various uses, applications, and types of ointments, along with their significance in different contexts.

Uses of Anointing:

- **Decorating and Refreshing:** Anointing was used to enhance beauty and rejuvenate the body.
- **Purification and Healing:** It played a role in cleansing rituals and treating illnesses and wounds.
- **Preparing for War and Burial:** Weapons were anointed before battle, and bodies were anointed before burial.

Application of Anointing:

- **Head, Face, Feet, Eyes:** Ointment was applied to various body parts, each with symbolic meaning.

Types of Ointment:

- **Perfumed and Expensive:** Ointments varied in fragrance and cost, with some being highly prized.
- **Medicinal and Commercial:** They were prepared by apothecaries and traded as commodities.

Social and Cultural Significance:

- **Joy and Respect:** Anointing was associated with celebrations and hospitality.

- **Neglect and Punishment:** Deprivation of anointing was a sign of mourning or a form of punishment.

- **Religious Practice:** Anointing was incorporated into religious rituals and fasting.

Overall, the document highlights the multifaceted role of anointing in Biblical times, encompassing physical, social, and spiritual dimensions.

Anointing

With oil.

Psalm 92:10 But my horn shalt thou exalt like the horn of an unicorn: I shall be anointed with fresh oil.

With ointment.

John 11:2 (It was that Mary which anointed the Lord with ointment, and wiped his feet with her hair, whose brother Lazarus was sick.)

WAS USED FOR

Decorating the person.

Ruth 3:3 Wash thyself therefore, and anoint thee, and put thy raiment upon thee, and get thee down to the floor: but make not thyself known unto the man, until he shall have done eating and drinking.

Refreshing the body.

2 Chronicles 28:15 And the men which were expressed by name rose up, and took the captives, and with the spoil clothed all that were naked among them, and arrayed them, and shod them, and gave them to eat and to drink, and anointed them, and carried all the feeble of them upon asses, and brought them to Jericho, the city of palm trees, to their Brethren: then they returned to Samaria.

Purifying the body.

Esther 2:12 Now when every maid's turn was come to go in to king Ahasuerus, after that she had been twelve months, according to the manner of the women, (for so were the days of their purifications accomplished, to wit, six months with oil of myrrh, and six months with sweet odours, and with other things for the purifying of the women;)

Isaiah 57:9 And thou wentest to the king with ointment, and didst increase thy perfumes, and didst send thy messengers far off, and didst debase thyself even unto Hell.

Curing the sick.

Mark 6:13 And they cast out many devils, and anointed with oil many that were sick, and healed them.

James 5:14 Is any sick among you? let him call for the elders of the Church; and let them pray over him, Anointing him with oil in the name of the Lord:

Healing wounds.

Isaiah 1:6 From the sole of the foot even unto the head there is no soundness in it; but wounds, and bruises, and putrifying sores: they have not been closed, neither bound up, neither mollified with ointment.

Luke 10:34 And went to him, and bound up his wounds, pouring in oil and wine, and set him on his own beast, and brought him to an inn, and took care of him.

Preparing weapons for war.

Isaiah 21:5 Prepare the table, watch in the watchtower, eat, drink: arise, ye Princes, and anoint the shield.

Preparing the Dead for burial.

Matthew 26:12 For in that she hath poured this ointment on my body, she did it for my burial.

Mark 16:1 And when the Sabbath was past, Mary Magdalene, and Mary the mother of James, and Salome, had bought sweet spices, that they might come and anoint him.

Luke 23:56 And they returned, and prepared spices and ointments; and rested the Sabbath day according to the commandment.

The Jews very fond of.

Proverbs 27:9 Ointment and perfume rejoice the heart: so doth the sweetness of a man's friend by hearty counsel.

Amos 6:6 That drink wine in bowls, and anoint themselves with the chief ointments: but they are not grieved for the Affliction of Joseph.

WAS APPLIED TO

The head.

Psalms 23:5 Thou preparest a table before me in the presence of mine enemies: thou anointest my head with oil; my cup runneth over.

Ecclesiastes 9:8 Let thy garments be always white; and let thy head lack no ointment.

The face.

Psalms 104:15 And wine that maketh glad the heart of man, and oil to make his face to shine, and bread which strengtheneth man's heart.

The feet.

Luke 7:38-39 And stood at his feet behind him weeping, and began to wash his feet with tears, and did wipe them with the hairs of her head, and kissed his feet, and anointed them with the ointment. 39 Now when the Pharisee which had bidden him saw it, he spake within himself, saying, This man, if he were a prophet, would have known who and what manner of woman this is that toucheth him: for she is a sinner.

The eyes.

Revelation 3:18 I counsel thee to buy of me gold tried in the fire, that thou mayest be rich; and white raiment, that thou mayest be clothed, and that the shame of thy nakedness do not appear; and anoint thine eyes with eyesalve, that thou mayest see.

OINTMENT FOR,

Richly perfumed.

Song of Solomon 4:10 How fair is thy love, my sister, my spouse! how much better is thy love than wine! and the smell of thine ointments than all spices!

John 12:3 Then took Mary a pound of ointment of spikenard, very costly, and anointed the feet of Jesus, and wiped his feet with her hair: and the house was filled with the odour of the ointment.

Most expensive.

2 Kings 20:13 And Hezekiah hearkened unto them, and shewed them all the house of his precious things, the silver, and the gold, and the spices, and the precious ointment, and all the house of his armour, and all that was found in his treasures: there was nothing in his house, nor in all his dominion, that Hezekiah shewed them not.

Amos 6:6 That drink wine in bowls, and anoint themselves with the chief ointments: but they are not grieved for the Affliction of Joseph.

John 12:3 Then took Mary a pound of ointment of spikenard, very costly, and anointed the feet of Jesus, and wiped his feet with her hair: and the house was filled with the odour of the ointment.

John 12:5 Why was not this ointment sold for three hundred pence, and given to the poor?
Prepared by the Apothecary.

Ecclesiastes 10:1 Dead flies cause the ointment of the Apothecary to send forth a stinking savour: so doth a little folly him that is in reputation for wisdom and honour.

An article of commerce.

Ezekiel 27:17 Judah, and the land of Israel, they were thy merchants: they traded in thy market wheat of Minnith, and Pannag, and honey, and oil, and Balm.

Revelation 18:13 And cinnamon, and odours, and ointments, and frankincense, and wine, and oil, and fine flour, and wheat, and beasts, and sheep, and Horses, and chariots, and slaves, and souls of men.

Neglected in times of Affliction.

2 Samuel 12:20 Then David arose from the earth, and washed, and anointed himself, and changed his apparel, and came into the house of the LORD, and worshipped: then he came to his own house; and when he required, they set bread before him, and he did eat.

2 Samuel 14:2 And Joab sent to Tekoah, and fetched thence a wise woman, and said unto her, I pray thee, feign thyself to be a mourner, and put on now mourning apparel, and anoint not thyself with oil, but be as a woman that had a long time mourned for the Dead:

Daniel 10:3 I ate no pleasant bread, neither came flesh nor wine in my mouth, neither did I anoint myself at all, till three whole weeks were fulfilled.

Neglect of, to guests, a mark of disrespect.

Luke 7:46 My head with oil thou didst not anoint: but this woman hath anointed my feet with ointment.

A token of joy.

Ecclesiastes 9:7-8 Go thy way, eat thy bread with joy, and drink thy wine with a merry heart; for God now accepteth thy works. 8 Let thy garments be always white; and let thy head lack no ointment.

Deprivation of, threatened as a punishment.

Deuteronomy 28:40 Thou shalt have olive trees throughout all thy coasts, but thou shalt not anoint thyself with the oil; for thine olive shall cast his fruit.

Micah 6:15 Thou shalt sow, but thou shalt not reap; thou shalt tread the olives, but thou shalt not anoint thee with oil; and sweet wine, but shalt not drink wine.

Why recommended by Christ in times of fasting.

Matthew 6:17-18 But thou, when thou fastest, anoint thine head, and wash thy face; 18 That thou appear not unto men to fast, but unto thy Father which is in secret: and thy Father, which seeth in secret, shall reward thee openly.